1. Introduction

Phishing is a cyber attack technique used by attackers to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, banking details, and personal data. It is one of the most common forms of social engineering attacks.

This report analyzes sample phishing emails, identifies phishing indicators, classifies risk levels, and provides prevention guidelines.

2. Tools Used

Gmail (for creating sample phishing emails)
Web Browser (URL inspection)
Google Docs (report documentation)
GitHub (repository submission)

3. Analysis Approach

The phishing emails were analyzed using the following method:
Examining sender email addresses
Inspecting suspicious URLs
Identifying urgency or threatening language
Checking domain spelling errors
Reviewing request for sensitive information
Classifying risk based on impact level

Phishing Email Example 1

From: support@secure-bank-alert.com
To: user@gmail.com
Subject: URGENT: Your Bank Account Will Be Suspended
Dear Customer,
We detected unusual activity in your bank account.
To avoid account suspension, please verify your account immediately.
Click the secure verification link below:
http://secure-bank-verification-login.com
Failure to verify within 24 hours will result in permanent suspension of your banking services.
Thank you,
Customer Security Team

(This is for the purpose of my internship regarding cyber security)

Subject:
URGENT: Your Bank Account Will Be Suspended

Identified Indicators:
Fake sender domain (not official bank domain)
Urgent and threatening language
Suspicious verification link
Generic greeting

Risk Classification:
High Risk – Phishing

Risk Explanation:
If the victim clicks the link and enters credentials, attackers can steal banking details and perform financial fraud.

Phishing Email Example 2

From: promo@amaz0n-deals.net
To: user@gmail.com
Subject: Congratulations! You Won a Free iPhone 🎉
Dear Winner,
You have been selected as the lucky winner of a Free iPhone 15 in our promotional campaign.
To claim your reward, click the link below and submit your details:
http://amaz0n-reward-claim.net
Hurry! This offer is valid for the next 12 hours only.
Best regards,
Promotions Department

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Subject:
Congratulations! You Won a Free iPhone
Identified Indicators:
Misspelled domain name (amaz0n)
Too-good-to-be-true reward
Suspicious link
No official signature

Risk Classification:
High Risk – Phishing

Risk Explanation:
Users may provide personal or payment information on fake websites.

Phishing Email Example 3

From: hr.department@gmail-support.com
To: employee@gmail.com
Subject: Immediate Action Required Document Verification
Dear Employee,
Our HR department is updating employee records.
Please submit your personal documents and login credentials using the link below:
http://company-employee-verification.net
Failure to complete verification today may result in temporary suspension of your employee account.
Regards,
HR Department

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Subject:
HR Department – Submit Documents Immediately
Identified Indicators:
Unofficial sender email
Urgency pressure
Request for sensitive documents
Threatening tone

Risk Classification:
High Risk – Phishing

Risk Explanation:
This could lead to identity theft and misuse of personal documents.

4. Common Phishing Indicators Identified

Fake or spoofed email addresses
Suspicious or misspelled domains
Urgent language
Requests for OTP/password
Threatening consequences
Fake rewards

5. Prevention & Awareness Guidelines

To prevent phishing attacks:
Verify sender email addresses carefully
Avoid clicking suspicious links
Never share OTP or passwords
Check website URLs before login

Enable Two-Factor Authentication
Report suspicious emails
Use spam filter.

6. Conclusion

Phishing attacks rely on deception and urgency tactics. By identifying suspicious email characteristics and educating users, the risk of credential theft and financial fraud can be significantly reduced. Awareness is the strongest defense against phishing.